

Oral Examination. BPHI 406: Topics in Metaphysics

1. Describe the origin of the doctrine of participation in Plato
2. What is the pitfall in Plato's theory of Forms with regard to the notion of participation?
3. How did the Middle Platonists reconcile the God of Plato with that of Aristotle?
4. Which conclusion did Plotinus draw from the One in Plato's Parmenides and the God of Aristotle?
5. Whose thoughts influenced Aquinas' notion of participation?
6. How do rational creatures participate in the being of God?
7. What are the static structures of participation according to Aquinas?
8. What are the dynamic structures of participation according to Aquinas?
9. What are three ways of participation according to Aquinas?
10. How is participation a means of limitation?
11. Discuss participation as a form of causality.
12. What is the problem of pantheism in participation?
13. What is the *actus essendi* of an individual subsisting being?
14. Describe the notions of essence and act of being (*esse*).
15. How do you describe essence and existence in created beings?
16. How do you describe essence and existence in immaterial beings?
17. What are the three stages of distinction between essence and existence?
18. How is God distinct from other immaterial beings with regard to essence and *esse*?
19. How do essence and existence unite material and immaterial created beings?
20. How do the essence and act of being (*esse*) distinguish created things from the Creator?
21. Is the distinction between essence and *esse* in finite beings real or logical?
22. What was the mediaeval priority with regard to essence or existence?
23. What was the view of Existentialists on the priority of essence or existence?
24. What did Democritus say about the theory of chance?
25. How could one trace the notion of chance in Plato?
26. What are the *per se* and *per accident* causes in Aristotle's notion of chance?
27. Discuss the idea of causal intersection in the doctrine of chance.
28. What is a chance event and its implication for free action?
29. How did the Modern and Contemporary philosophers conceive chance?
30. Discuss ethical determinism
31. Discuss the theory of *tertium non datur* of logical determinism.
32. What do you understand by *Condestinate* facts?
33. Discuss physical determinism
34. What is psychological determinism
35. What were the two academic tendencies of the time of William James?
36. How does William James apply the judgement of regret to tackle determinism?
37. What is the implication of abandoning the judgment of regret according to William James?
38. Does William James accept that human persons have free will?
39. What are the three main meanings of freedom?
40. What is the view of the Stoics on free will?
41. How did Aquinas explain God's pre-motion of human action?
42. What was the objection of the Molinism of the Jesuit school against Aquinas' doctrine of God's pre-motion?
43. What is Descartes' view on human free will?
44. Did the empiricists and materialists accept human free will? Explain.
45. Can one be said to have chosen freely when options are limited?

46. What is positive freedom?
47. What is dialectical freedom?
48. What were the two reasons considered by John Searle on the problem of free will?
49. What did Searle present as the typical image of determinism?
50. Which philosophical conundrum did Searle encounter on the problem of free will?
51. Why does physics deny free will, according to Searle?
52. Why does Searle think that it is impossible to abandon the reality of free will?
53. John Searle considered compatibilism inadequate. Why?
54. Walter Stace made a difference between freedom and determinism. Discuss.
55. Why did Walter Stace consider compatibilism as plausible?
56. Walter Stace argued that moral responsibility requires determinism. Explain.
57. How does the atomism of Democritus differ from that of the Epicureans with respect to free will?
58. Do human beings have free will, according to David Hume?
59. If determinism is true, what is its implication for human action?
60. Does St. Augustine argue that God foresees human action? Explain.
61. How did Aquinas explain God's omnipotence?
62. Is a sick person destined to recover or die irrespective of whether a physician is invited or not?
63. Discuss Louis de Molina's *scientia media* in relation to God's pre-motion.
64. If one decides to cross a muddy street, is the soiling of one's feet by chance? If yes, how? If not, why?
65. Are immaterial finite beings composed of matter and form?
66. Explain the theory of universal hylomorphism.
67. What was the position of St. Bonaventure regarding the doctrine of universal hylomorphism?
68. What is the meaning of fatalism?
69. How is fatalism related to determinism?
70. In a nutshell, state the two divergent academic tendencies of the 19th century that shaped William James' *Dilemma of Determinism*.